

EKHO Foundation

Job Description: Manager, National Initiatives and Policy

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Overview: This position is a mid level, full time position, reporting to the Lead, National Initiatives and Policy. The work will be at the intersection of Early Childhood Care and Education (ECCE), policy, and ecosystem development. Rocket Learning has been providing support to the central government on a variety of initiatives for the Anganwadi system - these will be supported by the senior manager.

The candidate will work directly with the National Initiatives and Policy (NIP) Lead and RL's Founders, to anchor, develop and expand crucial central partnerships with Government of India bodies including MWCD and NIPCCD, NITI Aayog, MoE and NCERT etc. The candidate will also help to meet requests, coordinate and mobilize internal resources across functional teams and state government partnerships.

Key Results

1. Catalyzing a high-quality ECCE system that leads to improved outcomes for children.
2. Impactful policies and initiatives for structural reform to drive action at the national and state level.
3. Strong relationships and partnerships with key government officials and civil society stakeholders.

Key Activities

1. Assist the NIP Lead in preparing briefs, strategies, policy documents, research and other knowledge products to support government action on early childhood education in the country.
2. Support central government partners with all requests including planning, organization, drafting, research, report writing, speech writing, M&E etc. related to the advancement of ECCE in India, particularly through the Anganwadi system.
3. Support planning, piloting and implementation of central government initiatives through to state and field level, including events, training programmes, curricula development, etc.
4. Collaborate with internal functional and State teams for support on national initiatives including policy input, comparative state studies, compiling best practices, field visits etc.
5. Partnering with government stakeholders and other partners to help establish the ECCE ecosystem in India.
6. Taking ownership and initiative to quickly deliver high-quality results in an unpredictable environment.

Eligibility Criteria:

1. 3-5 years of work experience in the development sector
2. Ability to think and communicate with utmost clarity through complex systems
3. Outstanding writing skills including research, structuring, drafting etc. with a quick turnaround
4. Enjoyment and ability to handle multiple workstreams, solve problems in a fast-paced and high pressure environment

Desirable Criteria:

1. Masters degree or certification in a relevant field incl. public policy, economics, development etc.
2. Mission driven, enthusiastic and optimistic - committed to transformation.
3. Patience and skills to deal with the opportunities and challenges of supporting governments.
4. Experience working at a central government ministry, internships included
5. Close alignment with RL's core values and principles.

About Rocket Learning
Rocket Learning is a high growth ed-tech non-profit with the mission of catalyzing early childhood education and community engagement in India. We work with the central government and state governments to impact over 1.5 million children. Established by a passionate founding group (IIT, IIM, HBS, MIT, MBB consultancies, start-up alumni), we are supported by an illustrious Board and backed by reputed funders.

Rocket Learning is part of the Indian government's Early Childhood Care and Education (ECCE) Taskforce and UNICEF's working group for Foundational Learning. Our innovations in promoting early learning have been profiled in Harvard Business School, UNESCO and Forbes case studies, researched by MIT, JPAL and Brookings, and awarded by Google, MIT Solve, WISE, DRK Foundation and the World Economic Forum.

More about our employees

We are a diverse team of passionate, energetic and optimistic folks with a shared ambition of transforming India's early education system at scale. Our key organisational values include always putting impact first, having a bias for action and innovation, both empowering and demanding accountability from each other, and sustaining a positive and fun culture and environment.

We're a home for you if you want to help build something that will improve the lives of millions through systems-level change. You'd also be able to build your skills and profile by working with an accomplished leadership team and being a part of very rapid growth. You can read more about our team here.

More about our benefits

Our key draws are skill-building, exposure, growth pathways and networks. In addition to all these: -

- For candidates interested in short-term, full-time stints - we offer a stellar role, title, experience and connections/recommendations to elite employers and academic institutions (our alumni are at HBS, Wharton, Yale and so on). For candidates interested in long-term stints - we offer a stellar role, the opportunity to grow rapidly with us in role and compensation as we scale.
- Along with an impactful role, there are other benefits like PF, Health Insurance, access to a wide network, counseling facilities that are available to our team members.

Process
If you are interested, please email us at careers@rocketlearning.org with your resume and cover note.